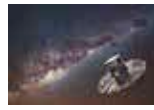




Panorama Upgrade

The throwable Panorama ball camera gets an upgrade. Check the link to know more <http://dgit.in/panupgrade>



ESA Maps Galaxy

The ESA launched a spacecraft to make a 3D map of the Milky Way. Read more for details <http://dgit.in/3543d>

Feature

TwitPic, in addition to which the clunky web browser, lack of multiple Twitter IDs and its dysfunctional tweet-syncing made it a sure fire failure in the face of Twitter enabled Android feature phones at the same price.



9 HP TouchPad (2011)

Like crazy Hollywood marriages, the touch screen tablet launched by HP didn't really last long in the market - 49 days. Even Kim Kardashian's marriage lasted 72 days! Launched only two years ago in 2011, the HP TouchPad was plagued by its amateur WebOS system (well yours would too if it was slapped together in just 9 months). Customers were left under-powered and abandoned in a new OS terrain as compared to the iOS and Android environments. Selling just about 25,000 units in America, HP tried to undercut the bad reviews and customer aversion by slashing prices. Sorry. No takers.

10 Qwikster (2011)

Another flash in the pan product, Qwikster took the dumbest aspects of business and combined them in one perfect service. Launched by Netflix as a standalone DVD rental (by snail mail) business in 2011 (weren't we already streaming back then?), Qwikster seemed like one of those redundant ideas you think are a joke. Until they become real. Then you scream with frustration. Intended to separate the DVD rental

business from Netflix's streaming cash cow business, Qwikster did nothing but piss people off. Filled with annoying requirements like separate accounts for the services, separate payment processing and complete mistreatment of customers in general, Qwikster was customer averse and cost Netflix a lot of goodwill before dying out a slow painful death. And no one came to the funeral.

11 Surface RT (2012)

Some people still have trouble figuring out what the RT exactly was - a tablet? An operating system? For laptops? For desktops? Retail store product? What exactly? And even as savvy geeks distinguished its features with a Jedi-like awareness, the broader user community couldn't really find a connection. A result of confused branding and shoddy marketing at the hands of Microsoft, it didn't



even work properly on the hardware it was designed for at the time. So Microsoft is doing what it thinks best - removing the "RT" from the name in the next series of Surface products and hoping that people won't get confused. Well, they may not be confused, but they might not really care either. Now where's my iPad?

12 Yahoo (2012)

Not all failures come in a neat package. Some are built in to the company's leadership, as was demonstrated by Yahoo's Marissa Mayer who somehow over saw the unbecoming of a brand. In 2013, Yahoo saw over thirty brand logo redesigns on its website, a complete redesign of its email product and a bungled marketing strategy promoting all these

changes. As Mayer inflicted her leadership on consumers and employees alike (she disbanded the company's telecommuting policy), Yahoo reached a real low point when its own employees couldn't use their own Yahoo mail properly. Faced



with complaints from thousands of users about glitches, failures, redesign hate and general discontentment, Mayer and Yahoo stood fast doing nothing and essentially ended up failing themselves.

13 Samsung Gear (2013)

Regrettably our dreams of acting like a secret agent are still yet to be fulfilled. The Samsung Galaxy Gear was supposed to be that gadget - the one we imagined as a child, yet adult in its functionality and utility. But at a USD \$300 price tag (USD \$369 in India at Rs. 22,900) and not enough features for the price, it sorely lacked in value for money as well as innovation. Alternatives like Sony's Smartwatch gave better value but honestly were just as unnecessary. Aiming to start up the wearable technology market Samsung ended up selling



nearly a million units but as incompatibility issues with other Android or Samsung phones became more and more realised, reviewers and critics alike have panned the device as an example of too little for too much. Seriously? 23,000 bucks!

